

Mango on Nokia WP7

Nokia has announced that its Windows Phone 7 devices will sport the latest update - Mango

CRACK THE CODE

Here's a **tip** - where's the last password you'll have to remember?

Add 27 to your answer which is the page for your next clue

Hint: the hint is in the clue.

Google Music and Google Storage announced

The Google I/O developer event created headlines right from the start, with the launch of Google Music, the opening of Google Storage for all and Android Market movie rentals. Android 3.1, with minor interface changes and improved USB controller support, was also introduced for tablets, while Ice Cream Sandwich, was teased.

Much of this showed the increasing foot-stepping that Google and Amazon are taking part in; with Google striking the first blow with Google Storage last year and Amazon striking the next with an Appstore for

Android that competes with Android Market. The battle continues.

Google Storage

At last year's Google I/O, a new service called Google Storage was announced. This



was in direct competition with Amazon's S3 (Simple Storage Service) since it used similar access mechanisms and conventions. Now, a year later, Google has made the service available for all without needing an invite. A number of

new features and changes have been made to Google Storage as well.

Among the new features that have been introduced are:

- A new free usage tier: Up to a certain quota, Google Storage is free of cost to those wanting to try out the service. This trial plan is only valid till the end of this year. The free usage quotas are as follows:
 - 5 GB of free storage,
 - 25 GB of free data transfer into Google Storage,
 - 25 GB of free data transfer out of Google Storage,
 - 2,500 free PUT, POST and

LIST requests, and

◦ 25,000 free GET, HEAD and other requests.

- A new storage region in Europe
- A new API: To make more improvements, a version 2 of the API has been released, although the old API is still available.
- OAuth 2.0: Google Storage now supports this new simpler authentication mechanism.
- Support for larger data sizes: Now objects of up to 5 TB can be uploaded.

Google Music

Google is launching a music storage and streaming service that seems all too familiar after the recent launch of Amazon's Cloud Player. Both of these services enable users to upload their music and store it online. Both enable one to stream their music collection to their PCs or Android devices. Amazon, of course, gets to add its bit of sweetness to the pot since it already offers digital music downloads.

Google Music promises to eradicate issues with managing music across multiple devices by storing it all online and keeping it in sync.

Google's Music service does boast of offline functionality, by making recently played tracks available offline. It also boasts of a more innovative mechanism for generating playlists than that used by "other smart playlist creation tools" (read: iTunes Genius). As of now the service is only open to US residents. 

Microsoft buys Skype for \$8.5bn, details "real-time communications" plans

Recent talks had both, Facebook and Google in a bidding war for Skype. A little later, news was floating around that Microsoft might be close to cracking a deal with the Luxembourg-based VoIP experts. On May 10th however, Microsoft officially announced in a press release that it will be acquiring Skype - a deal that is valued at roughly \$8.5 billion (₹3,85,000 crores), making it Microsoft's biggest ever buyout.

In the words of Steve Ballmer, the companies will work together to create a "future of real-time communications so people can easily stay connected to family, friends, cli-

ents and colleagues anywhere in the world."

The press release further details the roles Skype will play: "Skype will support Microsoft devices like Xbox and Kinect, Windows Phone and a wide array of Windows devices, and



Microsoft will connect Skype users with Lync, Outlook, Xbox Live and other communities. Microsoft will continue to invest in and support Skype clients on non-Microsoft platforms."

As for just how the merger will work, Skype will become

a new business division within Microsoft, with current Skype CEO, Tony Bates, taking the role of the President of the Microsoft Skype division. Skype has been around in the acquisitions world for a while. It was recently written off by eBay in 2009, after the internet company failed to effectively integrate itself into its ecosystems ever since it acquired the company in 2005. Perhaps the successful VoIP service is really meant to stand alone? Microsoft has a much better chance of pulling something off, with the WP7-Xbox-Windows ecosystem ripe for VoIP even on the consumer side, aside from the possibilities on the enterprise side. 